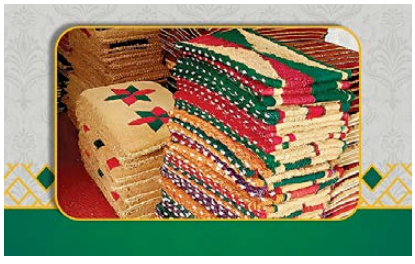


Araku Coffee has been featured at prestigious events, including being gifted to world leaders during the G20 Summit hosted by India, showcasing its stature as a product of national pride. The cultivation of Araku Coffee is a testament to sustainable and inclusive development. By adopting organic farming techniques and leveraging collective marketing efforts, the initiative has provided a steady income to thousands of tribal farmers. The GI tag has further bolstered its reputation, ensuring authenticity and safeguarding the interests of the growers. This transformation highlights how strategic branding and governmental support can create global success stories rooted in local traditions.

Alleppey Coir:

Alleppey coir, a distinguished Geographical Indication (GI), represents the age-old



craftsmanship of handloom coir mats, mattings, and carpets produced by traditional workers in the Ambalappuzha and Cherthala taluks of Kerala's Alleppey district since 1859. This unique product is renowned for its exclusive weaving techniques and small-scale manufacturing processes. Crafted from coir yarn spun from fibres extracted from coconut husks, the production involves a biological process called "retting", followed by sun drying and spinning into fine 2-ply coir yarn using traditional charkas. Each region imparts distinct characteristics to the yarn, with names like Anjengo, Aratory, and Vycome symbolizing their geographical origins. Alleppey pioneered the creation of value-added coir products such as doormats, mattings, and carpets, contributing significantly to the region's identity. The colour and texture of Indian coir have gained global acclaim, enhancing its demand in international markets. This GI recognition not only preserves traditional methods but also highlights the craftsmanship and regional heritage associated with Alleppey coir.

Madurai Malli:

Madurai Malli, the renowned jasmine (Malligai) variety of Jasminum sambac, is cultivated in Tamil Nadu's Madurai, Virudhunagar, Theni, Dindigul, and Sivagangai districts. Its buds range from round to oblong with short to medium corolla tubes and three to four whorls of petals. Local varieties include Gundu Malli, Ambu Malli, Ramabanam, Madhanabanam, and others.The flowers possess unique traits: intense fragrance, thick petals, long petioles, delayed blooming and discoloration, and superior shelf life.



Unlike similar varieties, Madurai Malli withstands freezing for over two days, ensuring freshness. Its sturdiness and long stalk make it easy to weave into garlands. A striking feature is its gradual color transition. Harvested in a greenish-white hue, it shifts to milky white by noon and creamy white by evening, retaining its vibrancy for over 24 hours without browning when untouched. These attributes, shaped by the region's unique geography, make Madurai Malli a symbol of quality, heritage, and lasting beauty, distinguishing it from jasmine flowers grown elsewhere.

Kanyakumari Matti Bananas:

Kanyakumari Matti Bananas achieved a GI Tag in 2021, facilitated by the Madurai Agribusiness Incubation Forum – Intellectual Property Facilitation Centre (MABIF - IPFC). Supported by the Ministry of MSME, this initiative boosted the banana's market value to INR 70-80 per kg, a significant improvement. The registered GIs include Tuticorin Macaroon, Authoor Betel Leaves, Madurai Marikolundhu (Davana), Cumbum Grapes, Vilachery Clay Toys, and Kanyakumari Matti Banana, underscoring its impact on preserving and promoting local heritage products.



Application Process

The application process for obtaining a GI registration requires a detailed assessment of the product's unique qualities and characteristics, which must be directly linked to its geographical origin. Applicants must present evidence of the product's distinctiveness and its connection to the region. Government agencies, such as the Geographical Indications Registry, are pivotal in processing and examining applications. Additionally, agricultural boards and organizations collaborate to assist farmers in navigating this process.

The legal framework for Geographical Indications is governed by both international agreements and domestic legislation. At the international level, the Agreement on Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS) provides a foundation for GI protection. Domestically, India's Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration & Protection) Act, 1999, serves as the key legislation. Enacted to fulfil India's TRIPS obligations, this Act establishes the framework for registration and protection of GIs. It details the procedures for obtaining registration, the rights conferred upon registered proprietors, and the penalties for unauthorized use of GI-protected products.

Empowering Local Products, Building Global Brands: The Government's GI Strategy

Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) has launched pioneering initiatives to promote inclusive growth and celebrate indigenous products. DPIIT has launched several initiatives aimed at enhancing awareness in the domain of GIs. Some of these initiatives include organising mahotsavs, trade shows, pavilions and fairs dedicated to GI. DPIIT has collaborated with media agencies to popularise GI by way of social media campaigns, documentary films, promotional videos, startup challenges, hackathons, promotion on metros, airlines and at airports, and sponsorship of shows on national television. DPIIT also periodically holds inter-ministerial consultations and conclaves to enhance collaboration, promotion and protection of GI in India. These combined initiatives contribute significantly to the growth and promotion of GI products.

Through sensitization programs, DPIIT aims to empower authorized users of GI products, promoting and preserving cultural heritage. Exhibitions, trade fairs, and Krishi Melas act as platforms to showcase GI products and create valuable networking opportunities. DPIIT recently facilitated participation of artisans engaged in the GI at the Autumn Fair, Birmingham, and Bazaar Berlin. These initiatives are closely aligned with key national goals such as 'Vocal for Local,' which encourages supporting indigenous products, 'Local to Global,' which aims to expand local products to international markets, and the larger vision of 'Aatmanirbhar Bharat' to make India self-reliant.

These efforts safeguard livelihoods, promote sustainable growth, and elevate India's unique heritage onto the global stage. By integrating tradition with innovation, the DPIIT ensures the protection and growth of GI Products, reflecting India's commitment to preserving its rich legacy while building a self-reliant and empowered nation.